

» AFTER

After just over two years in office, the Nixon administration had halved the number of US forces in South Vietnam. The burden of ground combat rested on the shoulders of the ARVN.

FIGHTING THEIR OWN FIGHT

The number of US military personnel in Vietnam fell to 239,000 in June 1971 and **continued to decline**. ARVN strength, on the other hand, was at 1,048,000, and these troops began to take on more responsibility for fighting the Viet Cong and NVA. When most **US troops left Vietnam**, however, the ARVN struggled without US backup.



VIETNAM SERVICE SLEEVE INSIGNIA